inally defined for High-Definition video, but was later abandoned as MPEG 2 was found to be sufficient).

Camcorder recording media and their associated encoding schemes are as follows:

❍ MicroDV: MPEG 2
❍ DVD-R, DVD-RW, DVD RAM: MPEG 2 with some variation
❍ Flash Memory: MPEG 1, MPEG 2 or MPEG 4

2.2.3 High Definition

All consumer-oriented camcorders on the market today—with the exception of a few—use Standard Definition video for the recording of digital video. SD video, as it is called, relies on the technologies used by the legacy video systems (NTSC, PAL, and SECAM). These legacy systems developed in the 1950s suffer from picture resolution problems which, though largely invisible to the eye, have an impact on clarity and colour fidelity. High Definition TV was introduced as a solution to the inherent problems with NTSC, PAL, and SECAM. HDTV offers very high-quality picture resolution and colour fidelity while supporting the movie theatre style aspect ratio of 16:9 compared to the 4:3 ratio of normal TV.

High Definition video, originally developed by JVC, was designed to be the cost-effective upgrade path for videographers, consumer hobbyists, and anyone with an interest in high-quality video.

HD video camcorders record onto the same MiniDV tapes as standard video, but use entirely separate video compression technology. HD video uses the popular MPEG 2 video codec for recording, while the SD uses the DV codec. HD video, as compared to SD video, has a much higher resolution, which improves the viewing experience, but there are some drawbacks. Due to the nature of MPEG 2 encoding, editing HD video is much more complex. This is especially apparent when splicing scenes together. To overcome this problem, high-end video editing software now